

TITLE: THE GREENWOOD MANOR MURDER CASE

CASE ID: GWM-2026-014

LOCATION:

Greenwood Manor, Ashford Hills

DATE OF INCIDENT:

14 October 2025

VICTIM:

Richard Coleman

AGE:

58

PROFESSION:

Businessman and Owner of Coleman Industries

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CHAPTER 1: THE NIGHT OF THE MURDER

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On the evening of October 14, 2025, a private family gathering was held at Greenwood Manor. The mansion belonged to Richard Coleman, one of the wealthiest businessmen in Ashford Hills.

The dinner began at 7:00 PM and ended around 9:30 PM. Present at the gathering were:

1. Richard Coleman (Victim)
2. Emily Coleman (Wife)
3. Daniel Coleman (Son)
4. Sarah Coleman (Daughter)
5. Michael Reed (Business Partner)
6. Olivia Reed (Michael's Wife)
7. James Walker (Family Lawyer)
8. Sophia Turner (House Manager)
9. Ethan Brooks (Personal Assistant)

According to witnesses, Richard appeared stressed during dinner. Several guests noticed that he had multiple arguments throughout the evening.

At approximately 10:15 PM, Richard announced that he was tired and would spend some time in his private study.

This was the last time he was seen alive.

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CHAPTER 2: DISCOVERY OF THE BODY

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At 11:40 PM, Sophia Turner went to the study to ask Richard whether the guests should be served coffee.

She knocked on the door several times but received no response.

After informing the family, Daniel Coleman forced the door open.

Inside the study, Richard Coleman was found lying on the floor beside his desk.

There was a deep stab wound in his chest.

A blood-covered antique letter opener was found near the body.

Police were immediately called.

Detective Laura Bennett arrived at the scene at 12:15 AM.

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CHAPTER 3: INITIAL EVIDENCE

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The crime scene revealed several important clues.

Evidence Item 1:

The antique letter opener found beside the victim.

Evidence Item 2:

A broken whiskey glass on the floor.

Evidence Item 3:

A handwritten note found in Richard's pocket.

The note read:

"If anything happens to me, the truth is hidden in the blue file."

Evidence Item 4:

A blue file found inside a locked cabinet.

The file contained financial records showing unauthorized transfers worth 5 million dollars.

Evidence Item 5:

A security camera outside the study hallway.

However, footage between 10:20 PM and 11:00 PM was mysteriously deleted.

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CHAPTER 4: THE SUSPECTS

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SUSPECT 1: EMILY COLEMAN

Relationship:

Wife of Richard Coleman.

Background:

Emily had been married to Richard for 30 years.

Possible Motive:

Recent arguments regarding Richard's alleged affair with a younger employee.

Alibi:

Emily claimed she was reading in her bedroom from 10:00 PM to 11:30 PM.

Issue:

No witness could confirm her alibi.

SUSPECT 2: DANIEL COLEMAN

Relationship:

Son of Richard.

Age:

32

Background:

Daniel managed one division of Coleman Industries.

Possible Motive:

Daniel recently discovered that Richard planned to remove him from the company board.

Alibi:

Daniel stated he was in the gym room from 10:00 PM to 11:15 PM.

Issue:

No security camera covered the gym area.

SUSPECT 3: SARAH COLEMAN

Relationship:

Daughter of Richard.

Age:

28

Background:

Sarah had accumulated large gambling debts.

Possible Motive:

Richard had refused to help her financially.

Alibi:

Sarah claimed she was making phone calls in the garden.

Issue:

Her phone records only partially supported her statement.

SUSPECT 4: MICHAEL REED

Relationship:

Business Partner.

Age:

60

Background:

Michael and Richard had worked together for 20 years.

Possible Motive:

Financial records suggested Michael may have been involved in missing company funds.

Alibi:

Michael stated he left the mansion at 10:10 PM.

Issue:

A nearby traffic camera showed his car passing the gate at 10:52 PM.

SUSPECT 5: ETHAN BROOKS

Relationship:

Personal Assistant.

Age:

29

Background:

Ethan handled confidential company documents.

Possible Motive:

Richard recently accused Ethan of leaking sensitive information.

Alibi:

Ethan claimed he was organizing paperwork in the office wing.

Issue:

His fingerprints were found on the blue file.

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CHAPTER 5: AUTOPSY REPORT

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Chief Medical Examiner:

Dr. Helen Carter

Findings:

1. Cause of Death:

Single stab wound to the chest.

2. Time of Death:

Between 10:35 PM and 10:50 PM.

3. Additional Findings:

Victim had traces of a sleeping medication in his bloodstream.

4. Conclusion:

The victim was partially sedated before being stabbed.

This indicated planning rather than a spontaneous attack.

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CHAPTER 6: INVESTIGATION PROGRESSES

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Detective Bennett interviewed all suspects.

A major discovery emerged from company financial records.

The missing 5 million dollars had been transferred through multiple shell companies.

One company was linked to Michael Reed.

Another company was linked to Ethan Brooks.

This created suspicion around both men.

However, investigators discovered something unexpected.

The transfers had actually been authorized using Richard's own credentials.

Someone with access to his private office could have performed the transactions.

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CHAPTER 7: THE DELETED FOOTAGE

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Cyber forensic specialists attempted to recover deleted security footage.

After several days, partial footage was restored.

Timeline:

10:22 PM

Richard enters study.

10:28 PM

Ethan Brooks enters study.

10:34 PM

Ethan leaves study.

10:38 PM

Unknown figure approaches hallway.

10:40 PM

Video corruption begins.

10:57 PM

Video resumes.

The unknown figure could not be clearly identified.

However, investigators noticed something important.

The figure appeared to limp slightly while walking.

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CHAPTER 8: NEW CLUES

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Detective Bennett reviewed interviews again.

She remembered that Michael Reed had a knee injury from a golf accident.

He occasionally walked with a slight limp.

This seemed significant.

A search warrant was executed at Michael Reed's home.

Investigators discovered:

1. Copies of hidden financial records.
2. Deleted email conversations with Richard.
3. Evidence of disputes over company ownership.

However, no direct evidence connected Michael to the murder weapon.

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CHAPTER 9: THE SECRET MEETING

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Phone records revealed Richard had scheduled a secret meeting at 10:30 PM on the night of his death.

The meeting participant was not listed.

Further investigation revealed that the phone number belonged to Michael Reed.

Michael eventually admitted meeting Richard.

According to Michael:

"Richard threatened to expose financial irregularities. We argued, but I left him alive."

Michael admitted the argument but denied murder.

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CHAPTER 10: THE HOUSE MANAGER'S OBSERVATION

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Sophia Turner provided a new statement.

She remembered seeing Daniel Coleman near the study hallway around 10:45 PM.

This directly contradicted Daniel's gym alibi.

When confronted, Daniel admitted he had gone upstairs briefly.

However, he denied entering the study.

Investigators searched Daniel's room.

Nothing suspicious was found.

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CHAPTER 11: THE LETTER OPENER

Forensic analysis of the murder weapon revealed:

Fingerprints found:

1. Richard Coleman
2. Sophia Turner
3. Ethan Brooks

No fingerprints from Michael Reed.

No fingerprints from Daniel Coleman.

No fingerprints from Emily Coleman.

Investigators believed the killer had wiped the weapon clean before leaving.

CHAPTER 12: THE HIDDEN RECORDING

A breakthrough occurred two weeks later.

A voice recorder was discovered behind books in the study.

The recording began at 10:31 PM.

Transcript Excerpt:

Richard:

"You stole from the company."

Michael:

"You have no proof."

Richard:

"I have everything in the blue file."

Michael:

"If that file reaches the board, we're finished."

Sound of argument.

Chair moving.

Door opening.

Recording ends abruptly.

The recording proved Michael argued with Richard shortly before death.

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CHAPTER 13: THE FINAL FORENSIC DISCOVERY

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Scientists tested microscopic fibers recovered from Richard's clothing.

The fibers matched a dark blue wool coat.

During interviews, investigators remembered that Michael Reed wore a dark blue wool coat that evening.

A search of the coat revealed tiny blood traces.

DNA testing confirmed the blood belonged to Richard Coleman.

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CHAPTER 14: CONFESSION

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Faced with overwhelming evidence, Michael Reed finally confessed.

Michael's Statement:

"For years, Richard trusted me.

I started moving money through shell companies.

At first, I thought I could return it later.

But the amount kept growing.

When Richard discovered everything, he threatened to expose me.

I met him in the study.

We argued.

I had already added sleeping medication to his whiskey earlier in the evening.

When he refused to stay silent, I grabbed the antique letter opener and stabbed him.

Afterward, I deleted part of the security footage.

I thought nobody would discover the truth."

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CHAPTER 15: CASE CONCLUSION

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Victim:

Richard Coleman

Actual Killer:

Michael Reed

Method:

Premeditated murder involving sedation followed by stabbing.

Primary Motive:

To prevent exposure of financial fraud involving stolen company funds.

Supporting Evidence:

1. Financial fraud records.
2. Secret meeting records.
3. Recovered security footage.
4. Voice recording.
5. Blood traces on Michael's coat.
6. Confession statement.

Final Verdict:

Michael Reed was charged with:

- First Degree Murder
- Financial Fraud
- Evidence Tampering
- Obstruction of Justice

Court Outcome:

Michael Reed was found guilty on all charges and sentenced to life imprisonment.

CASE STATUS:

CLOSED

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IMPORTANT FACTS SUMMARY

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Victim Name:

Richard Coleman

Murderer Name:

Michael Reed

Murder Date:

14 October 2025

Location:

Greenwood Manor

Murder Weapon:

Antique Letter Opener

Cause of Death:

Stab wound to chest

Additional Crime:

Financial Fraud worth 5 million dollars

Lead Detective:

Laura Bennett

Medical Examiner:

Dr. Helen Carter

Case Status:

Closed

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END OF CASE FILE

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